

Mount Olive Baseball Rec Rules/Guidelines



T-Ball / Farms Guidelines

April: The Tee-Ball Basics

In the month of April, the coaching emphasis will be on introducing the fundamental skills of baseball to our youngest athletes. Here are the key guidelines for April:

- Hitting off Tees: Players will start by hitting off tees, allowing them to focus on the basics of their swing without the added challenge of a moving ball.
- Batting Through the Lineup: Each team will have the opportunity for every player to bat through the lineup, ensuring maximum participation.

May & June: Transition to Coach Pitch

As we progress into May, our T-Ball players will have the chance to transition to coach pitch, introducing them to a new level of challenge. Here's what to expect:

- Coach Pitching with 5 Pitches: Players will experience coach pitching with a limit of 5 pitches. The coach can pitch from their knee in front of the batter.
- Return to Tee Hitting: If the player does not get a hit in the 5 pitches, the player will hit a ball into play off of a tee.
- Continued Lineup Structure: The lineup structure will remain consistent, allowing every player the opportunity to bat.

Rookies Guidelines

April: The Fundamentals Begin

In the month of April, the coaching should work on the fundamentals of baseball to our budding athletes. Coaches will be pitching to players, providing a controlled environment for skill development. Here are the key guidelines for April:

- Coach Pitching: Coaches will take the mound to pitch to their players.
- Strikes and Walks: The basics of batting are crucial, and we've simplified it for the Rookies level. A batter is out after 5 strikes, and they walk after 4 balls.
- Inning Structure: Each inning will consist of 3 outs or, if 3 outs are not obtained, the team batting will go through the lineup one time.

May & June: Progressing to the Next Level

As we move into May, we are introducing a progressive element to our game play. Older or more skilled players will have the opportunity to take on the pitching role. Here's what to expect in May:

- Pitching Transition: Older and more skilled players can pitch, adding an exciting dynamic to the game. However, if this is not feasible for your team, coaches can continue pitching.
- Strikes, Balls, and Coach Pitches: The strike count is reduced to 3, and after 4 balls, the coach will step in to pitch twice, maintaining a balance between challenge and support.
- Continued Structure: The inning and lineup structure remains the same, promoting consistency and familiarity for players.

Minors League Rules

For Rec baseball, the majority of rules followed are the rules set for by Babe Ruth League, Inc., with some variations:

- Games are 6 innings, 5 runs max on all innings except for the last inning.
- All games will be no new inning after 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- Balls and strikes are called letters to knees.
- Runners can steal 2nd and 3rd base, but only with two outs. Runners cannot advance on an overthrow from the catcher so the catcher should always try and throw it down. Stealing home is not permitted.
- Runners can advance 1 base on fielding overthrows.
- Runners can advance as many bases on balls hit to the outfield until it comes back to the pitcher and calls "time" to stop play.
- No leading and runners need to stay on base until the ball crosses home plate.
- Pitchers will pitch from 46 feet and the mound should always be measured before each game.
- Everyone should be included in the batting order and players should have played at least 3 innings on defense in the field so we all have to rotate between the players on our rosters.
- Players must slide into all bases on close plays. No head first slides, unless returning to the previous base.
- All rostered players must compete in at least half of scheduled regular season games to be eligible for playoffs.
- Make sure each player has fun!

Majors League Rules

For Rec baseball, the majority of rules followed are the rules set for by Babe Ruth League, Inc., with some variations:

- Games are 6 innings, 5 runs max on all innings except for the last inning.
- All games will be no new inning after 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- Balls and strikes are called letters to knees.
- Runners can steal any base including home.
- Runners can advance bases on fielding overthrows.
- Leading, dropped third strike, and in-field fly rules are in effect.
- Balks should be enforced, but only after a pitcher is given a warning. If a pitcher is warned, it should be considered a 'dead ball' and the pitch (if one was thrown) should not count. Umpires or coaches should explain to the pitcher why a balk was called to assist with the learning process.
- Pitchers will pitch from 50 feet and the mound should always be measured before each game.
- Everyone should be included in the batting order and players should have played at least 3 innings on defense in the field so we all have to rotate between the players on our rosters.
- Players must slide into all bases on close plays. No head first slides, unless returning to the previous base.
- All rostered players must compete in at least half of scheduled regular season games to be eligible for playoffs.
- Make sure each player has fun!